



Great Neck Public Schools

Social Studies Department · IT Handoff Brief

Civic Readiness Portal — Technology Department Brief

Eight integration items required to promote from staff pilot to full launch. None are needed before pilot.

For: Great Neck Public Schools leadership · district administration · Board of Education **Project lead:** Jon · Social Studies Department **Status:** v0.2.0 — feature-complete, ready for GNPS-hosted deployment

What this is

A web portal that **organizes and tracks every student's progress toward the New York State Seal of Civic Readiness** — the +1 Diploma Pathway approved by the Board of Regents in 2021. The Seal recognizes students who demonstrate civic knowledge, civic skills, civic mindsets, and civic experiences across grades 9–12.

Today, GNPS has no infrastructure for this. Peer Long Island districts (Seaford, 3 Village, Connetquot) collect evidence with Microsoft or Google Forms feeding counselor inboxes — no central tracker, no live progress, no audit trail. **Great Neck can do better.**

What's been built

A fully-functional portal that handles every NYSED-defined pathway. Students submit evidence; supervisors confirm hours by email; teachers push points for class-wide projects; counselors and the Civic Readiness Committee review and approve; admins generate the year-end NYSED audit pack.

Under the hood: 11 pathways (NYSED-compliant), 10 schema migrations, 62 automated tests, MIT-licensed open-source code on GitHub, Docker-based self-hosted deployment for GNPS infrastructure (zero third-party SaaS, zero recurring cost).

What it does for each audience

AUDIENCE	WHAT THEY GET
Students	A single GNPS-branded URL to submit hours, projects, and reflections. After every submission, an automatic personalized progress report email arrives – current points, what’s still needed, recent activity.
Families	The same progress report cc’d to the student’s faculty advisor. Phase 2: family-visible read-only dashboard.
Teachers	Quick-Push UI: pick a pathway (e.g. “1.5 pts for HS Civic Project”), paste a class roster, push the points to all students in one action. NYSED cap rules enforced automatically.
Counselors	Live caseload roster with auto-counted points from Infinite Campus data. Approval queue for reflections + supervisor-confirmed hours. Per-student PDF audit pack download.
Civic Readiness Committee	Topic-approval queue (pre-work) + scoring queue (post-work) using the official NYSED rubrics for research projects, civic projects, and the capstone.
Admin / Curriculum office	Full cohort roster, IC CSV import (auto-counts ~50–80% of points without student input), course catalog management, staff invites, year-end NYSED audit-pack zip export.
GNPS IT	Docker stack (<code>docker compose up</code>) on a single Linux VM. No third-party SaaS. Migration runner. Backup script. Full ops runbook.
NYSED auditors	Per-student audit-record PDF with point breakdown, evidence list, rubric scores, and audit-log excerpt. Roster CSV of all awarded students. Bundled as a year-end zip.

Why this matters strategically

1. **Closes a competitive gap.** Peer districts already have programs; GNPS doesn’t. Launching gives our students the same NYSED recognition.
2. **Surpasses peer implementations.** Their forms-based approaches lose evidence and stress counselors at year-end. Ours is a real tracker with audit defensibility.
3. **Serves civics education well.** The NYSED Seal is structurally aligned with the kind of civic engagement Great Neck values – service learning, advocacy projects, AP government, capstones. The portal makes it easy to recognize students who are already doing this work.
4. **District-controlled, district-owned.** Self-hosted on GNPS infrastructure. Student data never leaves the district. FERPA-compliant by architecture.

5. **Open-source artifact.** Other Long Island and NYS districts can adopt the GNPS implementation. Positions Great Neck as the originator of an open civic-readiness standard.

What’s needed to go live

STAKEHOLDER	ACTION	EFFORT
Curriculum & Instruction	Apply to NYSED via the SED Application Business Portal (~30 days state review)	one-time
C&I + Social Studies	Form / formalize the Seal of Civic Readiness Committee (NYSED-required body that approves project topics + scores capstones)	one-time
GNPS Technology	Provision a Linux VM, set up DNS, provide SMTP credentials, run <code>docker compose up</code>	~half a day
Privacy / Compliance	FERPA review of self-hosted architecture	~1 hour

Detailed runbook at [docs/it-runbook.md](#) . IT-specific brief at [docs/it-handoff-brief.md](#) . Full design document available as a polished PDF.

Cost

\$0/month in third-party fees. Runs on existing GNPS infrastructure. The only ongoing cost is the IT staff time for deployment + maintenance (estimated <1 hour/week at steady state).

Timeline

MILESTONE	STATUS
Research, design, spec, plan	✅ done
Phase 1 development	✅ done — feature-complete on Vercel/Supabase free tier as a working demo
Phase 1.5 self-host migration	✅ done — zero SaaS dependencies, Docker stack, full IT runbook
GNPS IT deployment	pending IT scheduling
First pilot cohort (Class of 2027)	targeted for fall 2026 onboarding
First seals awarded	targeted for June 2027 graduation
Phase 2: live IC integration + student SSO	targeted for school year 2027–28

Source + transparency

- **GitHub:** <https://github.com/SirhanMacx/gnps-civic-readiness> — public, MIT-licensed
- **Latest release:** v0.2.0 (2026-05-04) at <https://github.com/SirhanMacx/gnps-civic-readiness/releases/tag/v0.2.0>
- **Live demo (legacy free-tier; superseded by self-host):** <https://gnps-civic-readiness.vercel.app>

Asks of leadership

1. **Approve** the program launch as a district priority for the 2026–27 school year.
2. **Authorize** Curriculum & Instruction to file the NYSED application.
3. **Authorize** GNPS Technology to provision the deployment.
4. **Form** the Seal of Civic Readiness Committee with members who can pre-approve projects and score capstones (NYSED-required).
5. **Approve** the open-source publication and (eventually) the transfer of the GitHub repo to a GNPS-owned organization.

Contact

Jon · Social Studies Department · Great Neck Public Schools · civicseal@greatneck.k12.ny.us